Paisa Saathi PRD

1. Product Overview

Build **Paisa Saathi**, a Hindi-first, voice-first mobile financial guidance app for financially underserved workers in India, especially gig workers, delivery agents, househelp, construction workers, drivers, and other irregular income earners.

The app should feel like a simple trusted companion, not a traditional financial tool. It should help users understand everyday money questions, deductions, savings, safe investment basics, and simple next steps through short, reassuring conversations.

One-Line Pitch

Paisa Saathi is a multilingual voice-first financial companion that helps India's underserved workers understand money, save small amounts, and make safer financial decisions with trust, simplicity, and daily guidance.

Core Promise

"Simple, trustworthy money guidance in the user's own language."

MVP Positioning

For gig workers and financially underserved individuals who find money decisions confusing, Paisa Saathi is an AI-powered financial companion that provides simple, trustworthy, vernacular guidance, helping users make better financial decisions without complexity or fear.

2. Target Users

Primary MVP Users

- Tier-1 gig workers
- Delivery partners such as Swiggy, Zomato, Blinkit, and e-commerce delivery workers
- Ride-hailing drivers
- Workers who already use smartphones, UPI, and bank accounts
- Users who are digitally connected but not digitally confident

Secondary Future Users

- Househelp workers
- Construction workers
- Security guards
- Daily wage earners
- Street vendors

- Small shop owners
- Self-employed workers
- New bank account holders and PMJDY beneficiaries

User Traits

- Irregular income
- Low financial literacy
- Vernacular-first
- Limited time and attention
- Fearful of fraud or hidden charges
- More likely to trust peers, employers, NGOs, supervisors, and WhatsApp groups than standalone financial apps

3. Product Principles

1. Reduce thinking, do not add more.
2. Be voice-first and text-friendly.
3. Use simple Hindi by default.
4. Avoid financial jargon.
5. Keep answers short, usually 2-3 lines.
6. Never judge the user.
7. Build trust through clear disclaimers.
8. Do not move money or ask for sensitive credentials.
9. Do not show complex dashboards, charts, or analysis-heavy screens.
10. Give small, practical next steps.

4. MVP Scope

Must-Have Features

11. OTP login
12. Language selection
13. AI chat as the primary screen
14. Voice input and text input
15. Hindi-first conversational responses
16. Quick suggestion chips
17. Deduction explanation flow
18. Spending decision guidance flow
19. Savings guidance flow
20. Safe investment education flow
21. Basic alerts and explanations
22. Trust layer messages
23. Simple onboarding with job type selection

24. AI safety guardrails and fallback responses

Should-Have Features

25. WhatsApp-like conversational UI behavior
26. Basic user profile with preferred language and worker type
27. Simple alert history
28. Feedback buttons on AI responses
29. Repeat-use nudges
30. Multilingual-ready architecture beyond Hindi

Could-Have Features

31. WhatsApp bot entry point
32. Audio playback of assistant responses
33. Community/referral prompts
34. Basic savings goal tracking
35. Partner/employer onboarding code

Out of Scope for MVP

- No investment marketplace
- No loan distribution
- No direct purchase of financial products
- No money movement
- No wallet
- No bank transfer
- No UPI payment execution
- No complex financial planning tools
- No complex analytics dashboard
- No exact investment recommendations
- No risky investment advice
- No request for OTP, PIN, full card number, bank password, or other sensitive credentials

5. Core User Journeys

Journey 1: First-Time User Onboarding

36. User opens app.
37. Entry screen says: "Get help with your money."
38. User taps Continue.
39. User selects language. MVP should support Hindi as default and be structured for future vernacular languages.
40. User enters phone number.
41. User verifies OTP.

42. User selects job type, such as delivery partner, driver, househelp, construction worker, security guard, shop worker, or other.
43. App shows trust messages:
    - "We don't move your money."
    - "No hidden charges."
    - "Only simple guidance."
44. User lands directly on AI chat.

Journey 2: Ask AI for Money Help

45. User lands on AI chat.
46. User can type or tap microphone.
47. Quick suggestions are visible:
    - "Check my money"
    - "Why deduction?"
    - "How to save?"
    - "Can I spend today?"
48. User asks a money question in simple Hindi or Hinglish.
49. AI replies in simple Hindi, maximum 2-3 lines.
50. AI gives one small next step.
51. User can tap helpful/not helpful.

Journey 3: Deduction Explanation

52. User asks: "₹500 kyun kate?" or "Why was money deducted?"
53. App asks for safe non-sensitive context if needed, such as "Kya aapko recharge, bank charge, ya subscription yaad hai?"
54. AI explains 2-3 simple possible reasons:
    - Recharge
    - Bank charge
    - Subscription
    - EMI or bill
    - UPI/autopay
55. AI suggests one simple action:
    - Check SMS from bank
    - Check UPI app history
    - Cancel unwanted autopay

- Ask bank branch/customer care if unclear

56. App must not ask for OTP, PIN, or bank login.

Journey 4: Savings Guidance

57. User asks: "How can I save small amounts?"
58. AI gives realistic, small steps:

- Save ₹50 today

- Avoid one small expense

- Keep money aside after receiving income

59. AI uses encouraging language.
60. App may show a simple "Save today" nudge.

Journey 5: Spending Decision

61. User asks: "Can I spend today?"
62. AI does not perform exact calculations unless user provides safe details.
63. AI encourages checking balance, keeping aside a small amount, and spending only after essentials.
64. Response should be safe and non-prescriptive.

Journey 6: Safe Investment Education

65. User asks: "Where can I invest?" or "How to go about investment?"
66. AI explains basic safe principles:

- Start small

- Understand before investing

- Avoid risky schemes

- Use regulated options only

67. AI must not recommend risky investments or specific high-return schemes.
68. AI should suggest speaking to a trusted regulated advisor or official source for product selection.

Journey 7: Basic Alert

69. App displays a simple alert such as "₹500 deducted."
70. User taps alert.
71. Alert detail explains: "This may be because of..."
72. Alert detail shows: "Next time, you can..."
73. User can ask follow-up question in AI chat.

6. Information Architecture

Required Screens

74. Entry Screen
75. Language Selection Screen
76. OTP Login Screen
77. OTP Verification Screen
78. Job Type Selection Screen
79. Trust Confirmation Screen
80. AI Chat Screen
81. Alerts Screen
82. Alert Detail Screen
83. Savings Guidance Screen or Chat Flow
84. Basic Profile/Settings Screen

Optional Minimal Home

If included, the home screen must be extremely simple with only 2-3 cards:

- Ask AI
- My Alerts
- Help me save

The AI chat should remain the default landing screen after onboarding unless product design chooses the minimal home as a thin routing layer.

7. UX Requirements

Visual Direction

- Friendly, clean, accessible mobile UI
- Minimal text
- Large touch targets
- Prominent microphone button
- Clear Hindi-first copy
- Avoid clutter
- Avoid complex financial terms
- Avoid charts unless absolutely necessary
- Avoid dense cards and dashboards

Interaction Requirements

- User should always be able to ask by voice or text.
- Quick suggestion chips should reduce typing effort.

- Chat should support short assistant replies.
- Every AI answer should include reassurance or one practical next step when appropriate.
- Trust messages should appear during onboarding and in settings/help.
- Financial safety disclaimer should be visible but not intimidating.

Accessibility Requirements

- Large readable text.
- High contrast.
- Touch targets at least 44x44 points.
- Voice input must be easy to find.
- App should support low-literacy usage through simple labels and audio-friendly interactions.

8. AI Assistant Requirements

Assistant Identity

The assistant is "Paisa Saathi", a friendly financial helper for gig workers in India such as delivery agents, drivers, and househelp.

Global AI Prompt

Use this as the base system behavior:

```
You are "Paisa Saathi", a friendly financial helper for gig workers in India such as
delivery agents, drivers, househelp, construction workers, and other underserved workers.

Your goal is to help users understand their money in a very simple, safe, and friendly
way.

Language:
- Always respond in simple Hindi by default.
- Use very easy, conversational words.
- Support Hinglish input.

Style:
- Keep answers short, maximum 2-3 lines.
- Avoid financial jargon.
- Use simple examples if needed.

Tone:
- Friendly, calm, and reassuring.
- Never judge the user.
- Speak like a helpful friend.

Safety Rules:
- Do not give complex financial advice.
- Do not suggest risky investments.
```

```
- Do not ask for sensitive information such as OTP, PIN, full card number, bank password, or UPI PIN.
- Do not claim to move, protect, invest, or recover money.
- If unsure, say: "मुझे पूरी जानकारी नहीं है, लेकिन मैं समझाने की कोशिश करता हूँ"

Behavior:
- Focus on simple guidance, not detailed analysis.
- Always suggest small, practical next steps.
- Help reduce confusion and fear.

Remember:
This is not a banking app. You are a simple helper.
```

AI Use Cases

85. Conversational guidance
86. Explaining transactions or deductions
87. Simplifying financial concepts
88. Savings nudges
89. Safe investment education
90. Alert explanation
91. Government benefit awareness in future versions

Controlled Agentic Behavior

The app may use controlled agent-like flows, but the AI must not act autonomously on user money.

Allowed controlled agents:

- Financial Explanation Agent: input is transaction-like context; output is a simple explanation.
- Savings Suggestion Agent: input is spending pattern or user question; output is a small savings suggestion.
- Alert Agent: detects or receives an unusual deduction alert and triggers a simple explanation.

Not allowed:

- Autonomous money movement
- Autonomous investment selection
- Loan recommendation or distribution
- Collecting sensitive credentials
- Making guaranteed claims

9. Functional Requirements

Authentication

- Phone number login with OTP.
- Mock OTP is acceptable for local MVP development if clearly isolated.

- Store authentication state securely on device.
- Do not ask for unnecessary personal data.

Language Selection

- Hindi must be the primary MVP language.
- Store user language preference.
- Architecture should allow adding other Indian languages.

User Profile

Capture only minimal profile fields:

- Phone number or user ID
- Preferred language
- Job type
- Onboarding completed flag
- Created date

Chat

- User can send text message.
- User can use voice input.
- App converts speech to text.
- Chat sends message to backend.
- Backend applies AI guardrails and returns response.
- Chat history is stored locally or in backend depending on implementation choice.
- Show loading state while AI responds.
- Show safe fallback on error.

Alerts

- MVP can use simulated or manually generated alerts.
- Alert fields:

  - Amount

  - Alert type

  - Short title

  - Simple explanation

  - Suggested next step

  - Created date

  - Read/unread status

- Alerts must not imply the app has full bank access unless real integrations are added later with consent.

Savings Guidance

- Provide small practical suggestions.
- Do not require exact budget calculations.
- Examples:

- "Aaj ₹50 alag rakh sakte ho."

- "Agar zaroori nahi hai, ye kharcha kal tak rok sakte ho."

- "Income aate hi thoda paisa side mein rakhna easy hota hai."

Trust Layer

Show these messages in onboarding, profile/help, and relevant moments:

- "We don't move your money."
- "No hidden charges."
- "Only guidance."
- "Never share OTP, PIN, or UPI PIN."

10. Non-Functional Requirements

Performance

- App should open quickly on low-to-mid Android phones.
- Chat response loading should show within 500 ms.
- AI response should ideally return within 5 seconds under normal conditions.

Reliability

- App must handle AI errors gracefully.
- App must handle no internet state.
- App must preserve onboarding state.
- App must avoid duplicate OTP screens after login.

Privacy

- Collect minimal data.
- Use consent-based data handling.
- Do not store sensitive financial credentials.
- Do not request OTP/PIN except the app login OTP.
- Clearly distinguish app OTP from bank OTP.

Security

- Use HTTPS for backend APIs.
- Store auth token securely.
- Validate all backend inputs.
- Log AI safety events without storing sensitive user content where possible.

Localization

- Default copy should support Hindi.
- Keep all UI strings in localization files.
- Support future languages without rewriting screens.

11. Suggested Technical Stack

Use a lightweight, scalable, API-first stack suitable for rapid MVP development.

Mobile Frontend

- React Native with Expo or bare React Native
- Android-first, iOS-compatible
- TypeScript recommended

Backend

- Node.js/Express or Python/FastAPI
- REST APIs for MVP
- Stateless AI endpoint with guarded prompt orchestration

AI Stack

- LLM API such as OpenAI or an approved open-source model
- Speech-to-text API for voice input
- Basic moderation/safety checks
- Prompt templates for each supported flow

Data Layer

- Minimal user data
- PostgreSQL, SQLite, Supabase, Firebase, or similar MVP-friendly store
- No heavy dependency on financial integrations initially

Cloud

- AWS, GCP, Firebase, or Supabase for scalable MVP deployment

12. Suggested App Architecture

Frontend Modules

- auth
- onboarding
- chat
- voice
- alerts
- savings
- profile
- localization
- trust

Backend Modules

- auth
- users
- chat
- aiGuardrails
- alerts
- feedback
- health

API Endpoints

```
POST /auth/request-otp
POST /auth/verify-otp
GET /me
PATCH /me
POST /chat/message
GET /chat/history
POST /chat/feedback
GET /alerts
GET /alerts/:id
PATCH /alerts/:id/read
GET /health
```

13. Data Model

User

```
{
  "id": "uuid",
  "phoneNumber": "string",
  "preferredLanguage": "hi",
  "jobType": "delivery_partner",
```

```
  "onboardingCompleted": true,
  "createdAt": "datetime",
  "updatedAt": "datetime"
}
```

ChatMessage

```
{
  "id": "uuid",
  "userId": "uuid",
  "role": "user | assistant",
  "message": "string",
  "language": "hi",
  "intent": "deduction_explanation | savings_help | spending_decision |
investment_education | general",
  "createdAt": "datetime"
}
```

Alert

```
{
  "id": "uuid",
  "userId": "uuid",
  "amount": 500,
  "currency": "INR",
  "title": "₹500 deducted",
  "explanation": "Simple explanation text",
  "nextStep": "Simple action text",
  "status": "unread | read",
  "createdAt": "datetime"
}
```

Feedback

```
{
  "id": "uuid",
  "userId": "uuid",
  "messageId": "uuid",
  "rating": "helpful | not_helpful",
  "createdAt": "datetime"
}
```

14. Screen-Level Acceptance Criteria

Entry Screen

- Shows simple message: "Get help with your money."
- Shows one primary Continue CTA.
- Does not show financial jargon.

Language Selection

- Shows Hindi as primary option.
- Stores language preference.
- Continues to OTP login.

OTP Login

- Accepts phone number.
- Requests OTP.
- Verifies OTP.
- Handles invalid OTP state.
- Does not confuse login OTP with bank OTP.

Job Type Selection

- Provides simple job type options.
- Allows "Other."
- Saves selection to profile.

Trust Confirmation

- Shows "We don't move your money."
- Shows "No hidden charges."
- Shows "Only guidance."
- Shows "Never share OTP, PIN, or UPI PIN."
- Continues to chat.

AI Chat

- Is default post-onboarding landing screen.
- Supports text input.
- Supports voice input or clearly marked voice placeholder if STT is not connected yet.
- Shows quick suggestion chips.
- Returns Hindi-first assistant answer.
- Keeps answer short.
- Shows safe fallback if AI fails.

Alerts

- Shows list of simple alerts.
- Alert detail includes amount, reason, and next step.
- Does not imply real bank integration if using mock data.

Profile/Settings

- Shows language and job type.
- Allows logout.
- Shows trust and safety reminders.

15. AI Acceptance Criteria

For each AI response:

- Response is in simple Hindi by default.
- Response is maximum 2-3 lines unless user asks for more detail.
- Response avoids financial jargon.
- Response does not ask for OTP, PIN, UPI PIN, bank password, or full card number.
- Response does not recommend risky investment.
- Response does not guarantee outcomes.
- Response includes one practical next step where appropriate.
- If uncertain, response says: "मुझे पूरी जानकारी नहीं है, लेकिन मैं समझाने की कोशिश करता हूँ"

16. Testing Plan

Qualitative Testing

Test with real delivery agents, gig workers, househelp, and construction workers.

Observe:

- Can users understand responses?
- Do users trust the app?
- Do users complete onboarding?
- Do users ask questions without help?
- Do users return to the app?

Prototype Testing

- Test clickable prototype flows.
- Validate navigation simplicity.
- Validate interaction clarity.
- Validate whether voice input is visible enough.

AI Testing

Test scenarios:

- Wrong answers
- Ambiguous queries

- Deduction explanation
- Savings help
- Spending decision
- Investment education
- Attempts to share OTP/PIN
- Requests for risky investment advice

Required behavior:

- Guardrails trigger correctly.
- AI says it is unsure when needed.
- AI refuses sensitive or unsafe requests.
- AI stays short and simple.

Pilot Launch

- Launch to 50-100 users.
- Track repeat usage.
- Track drop-offs.
- Track questions asked.
- Track user satisfaction.

17. Success Metrics

Acquisition

- App installs
- Registrations
- Activation rate

Engagement

- DAU
- MAU
- DAU/MAU ratio
- Queries per active user
- Session frequency
- Alerts opened

Retention

- 7-day retention
- Repeat usage
- Return visits after alert or nudge

AI Quality

- Helpful response rate
- Not helpful response rate
- Hallucination rate
- Unsafe response rate
- Fallback rate
- Response satisfaction

Business

- Premium conversion rate, future
- Partner referral conversion, future
- CSAT/NPS

18. Risks and Mitigations

Low Trust

Risk: Users fear fraud and hidden charges.

Mitigation: Show trust messages clearly, do not request sensitive credentials, and communicate "guidance only."

Low Literacy

Risk: Users may not read dense text.

Mitigation: Voice-first design, simple Hindi, large buttons, minimal copy.

Incorrect AI Responses

Risk: AI may hallucinate or provide unsafe advice.

Mitigation: Guardrails, intent-specific prompts, unsafe-topic refusal, fallback responses, and user feedback loop.

Low Retention

Risk: Users may try once and not return.

Mitigation: Simple alerts, small savings nudges, helpful quick suggestions, referral/community strategy.

Misunderstood Financial Role

Risk: Users may think the app is a bank or can move/recover money.

Mitigation: Repeated disclaimer: "This is not a banking app. We only give guidance."

19. Implementation Instructions for Claude Code

Build an MVP mobile app and backend for Paisa Saathi using the PRD above.

Preferred Build Output

Create:

92. React Native mobile app using TypeScript.
93. Backend API using Node.js/Express or Python/FastAPI.
94. Simple local or hosted database setup.
95. Environment variable placeholders for AI and speech-to-text providers.
96. Mock data for alerts.
97. Hindi-first localization strings.
98. README with setup instructions.

Implementation Priorities

99. Complete onboarding flow.
100. Complete AI chat screen.
101. Add voice input integration or a clearly isolated STT placeholder.
102. Add guarded AI backend endpoint.
103. Add alerts list and detail screen.
104. Add profile/settings with trust messages.
105. Add tests for AI guardrails and key API endpoints.

Important Build Constraints

- Do not build a complex financial dashboard.
- Do not add investment marketplace or loan flows.
- Do not build money movement.
- Do not ask for sensitive banking credentials.
- Keep UI extremely simple.
- Keep text Hindi-first and low-literacy friendly.
- Make the app Android-first.

20. Definition of Done

The MVP is done when:

- A new user can complete onboarding with language, OTP, and job type.
- User sees trust messages before using the app.
- User lands on AI chat.
- User can ask by text.
- User can use voice input or a clear voice placeholder.
- AI responds in simple Hindi with guardrails.

- User can open alerts and see simple explanations.
- User can view profile/settings and safety reminders.
- The app handles loading, empty, error, and offline states.
- No prohibited financial product or money movement flow exists.
- README explains how to run mobile app, backend, AI configuration, and tests.